TAKUDZIDZA BY TAKU

Redesign 2: Taku Education brand, workspace layout, surfaces

Takudzidza now wears the Taku Education brand and works like a study workspace: sources on the left, the chat in the middle with the question box always in reach, study tools on the right. It is live at takudzidza.vercel.app, and the first visit downloads less than half of what it did.

What changed

- **Brand.** The Education mark from the kit, unchanged, and the approved horizontal lockup with "by Taku" on the public pages and sign in. New app icons drawn from the mark. The old tile T is gone from the app, `art/brand` and `public`. No teal anywhere.
- **Type and colour.** Inter 400, 500 and 600 and JetBrains Mono, self hosted, replacing Lexend. The new palette, with every text and background pair at WCAG AA in light and dark, checked by a test.
- **Surfaces.** Honey waves behind the app, three surface levels with warm shadows, a frosted top bar. People stand on the page as cutouts; scenes fade into the page. No arch, circle or box photo frames.
- **Notebook workspace.** A full height shell where only the panes scroll. A sources rail that folds to a strip once chatting and remembers the learner's choice. Numbered citation markers open the page with the quote highlighted. A Study tools panel with summary, flashcards, practice paper, mind map, Scroll and step by step widgets.
- **Question box.** Two chips with a one line explanation each: Only my notes or My notes plus Taku's ideas, and Show me the answer or Guide me. Under each answer: Quiz me on this, Make 5 flashcards, Explain it simpler, copy and read aloud.
- **Phone.** Chat first, sources and tools in sheets, the tab bar steps aside while typing, and the question box stays above the keyboard.
- **Also.** A Home dashboard, Ask Taku on the same layout with past chats, focus mode for flashcards, practice papers and Scroll, Settings in two columns of grouped cards, and a new link preview image.

Checks

- All tests ran in mock AI mode, with no live AI call.
- Lint, typecheck and 286 unit tests pass, including contrast, brand and the no dash copy rule.
- 44 browser journeys pass on phone and desktop, none skipped. New ones cover the sources rail, the question box after six answers on a 360 by 640 phone and a 1280 by 800 laptop, citations, focus mode and photo frames.
- Live site checked after deploy: new script and icon served, landing loads with no console errors on desktop and phone. No account was made on production.

First visit download

	Before	After
Page	1302.3 KB	687.3 KB
Service worker	662.8 KB	131.7 KB
Total first visit	**1965.1 KB**	**819.0 KB**

Not done, and things to know

- No exam countdown on Home yet: there is no exam date in the data to count down to.
- Explain it simpler works with the real AI but has no recorded mock answer, so the browser tests do not cover it.
- Dark mode is for the signed in app only. Public pages stay light because the lockup is drawn for cream.
- In the header the "by Taku" line is about 5 px tall, as drawn in the approved lockup. A header version of the lockup would be a brand decision.
- Production Convex settings were not changed. Items from the MVP list (email, Google, SMS provider, caps) are still open.

How to roll back

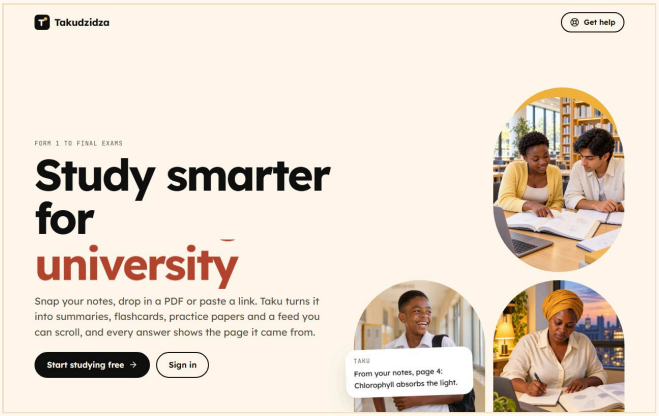
- The tag `checkpoint-before-redesign` marks the app before this work (df9569d).
- To go back: `git checkout checkpoint-before-redesign`, then deploy that build the usual way (docs/DEPLOY.md). No Convex function or data changed, so only the site needs redeploying.
- To undo in history without rewriting it: `git revert babf056` on main, then deploy.

Before and after

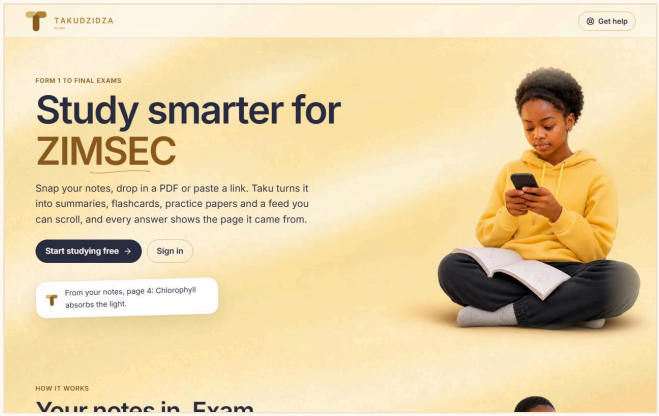
Screenshots from a local run in mock AI mode, with a test learner. Desktop at 1280 by 800, phone at 360 by 780.

Landing, desktop

Before

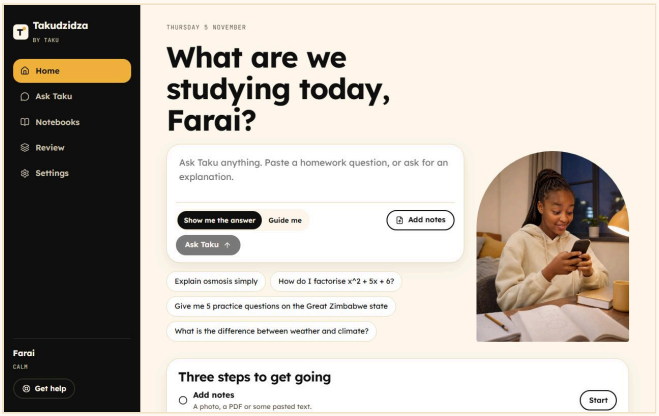


After

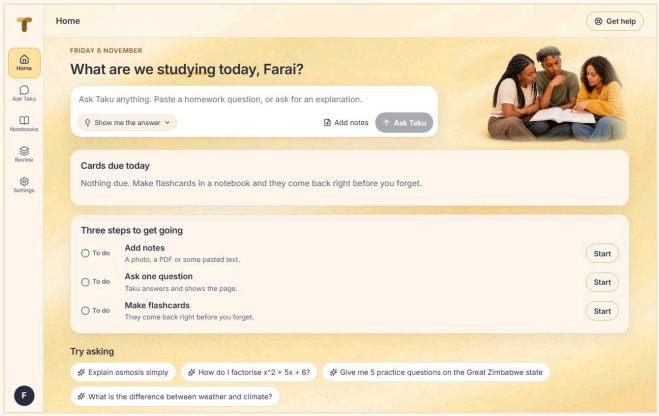


Home, desktop

Before

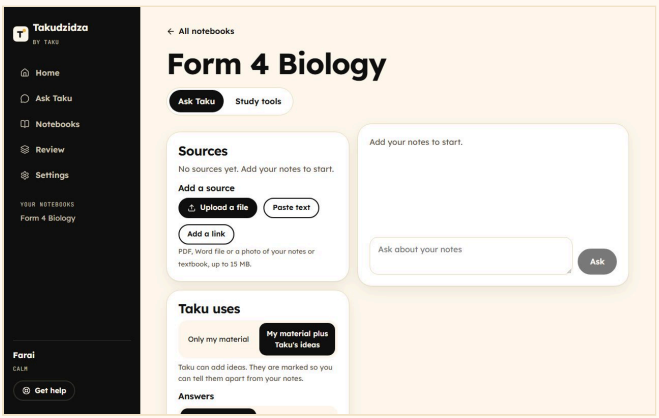


After

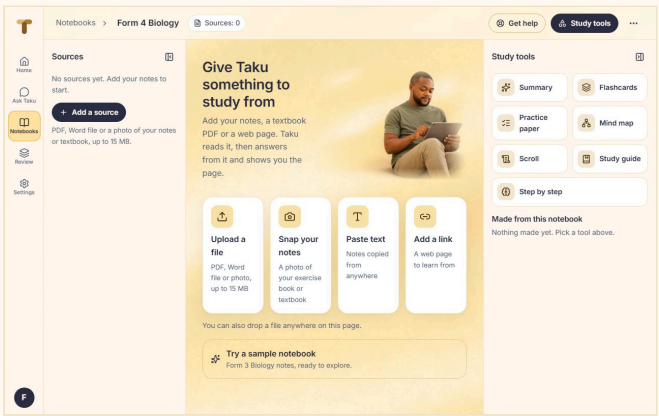


Empty notebook, desktop

Before

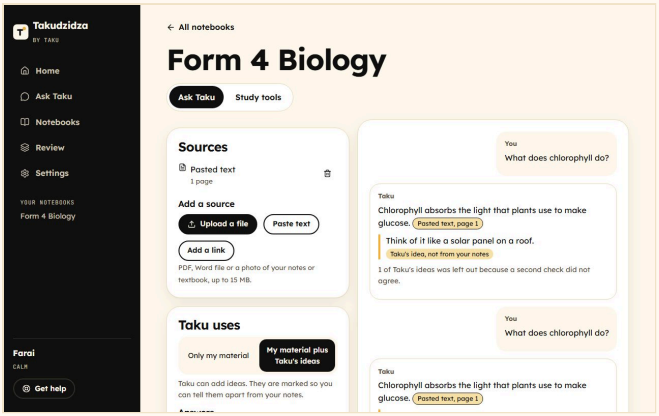


After

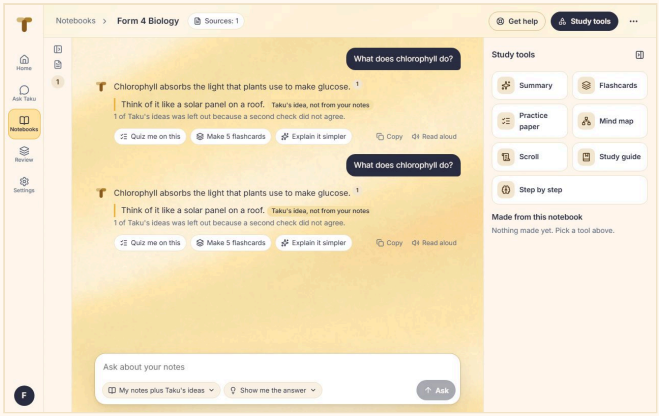


Notebook with answers, desktop

Before

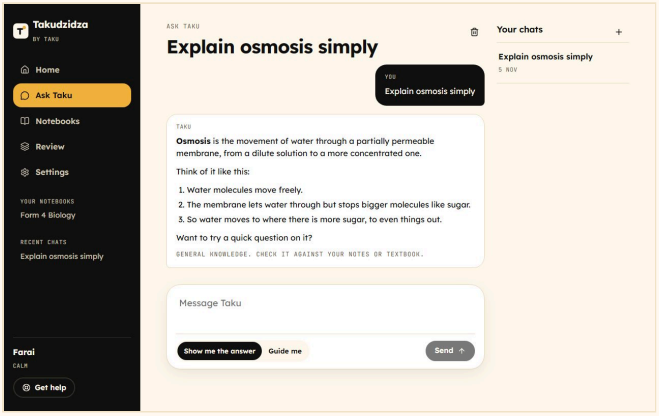


After

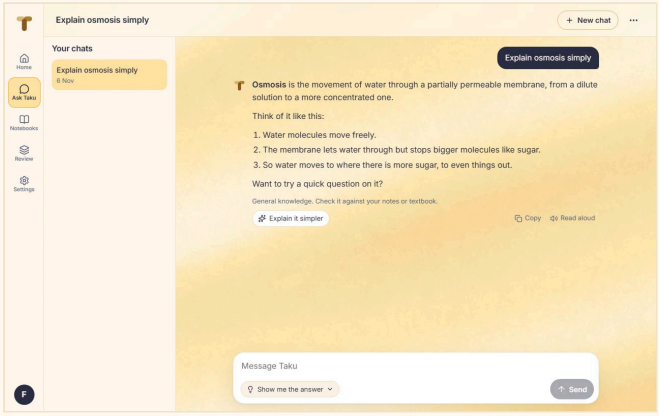


Ask Taku, desktop

Before

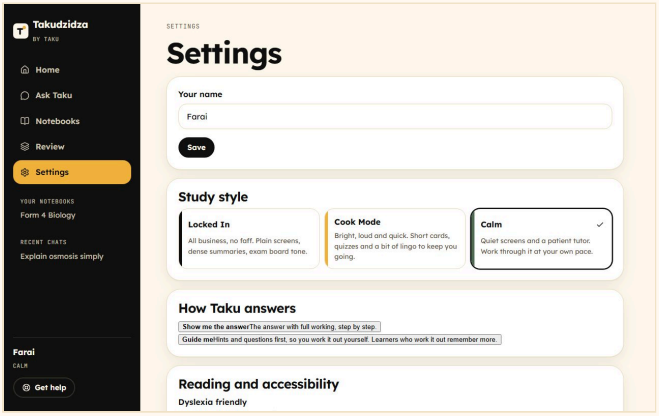


After

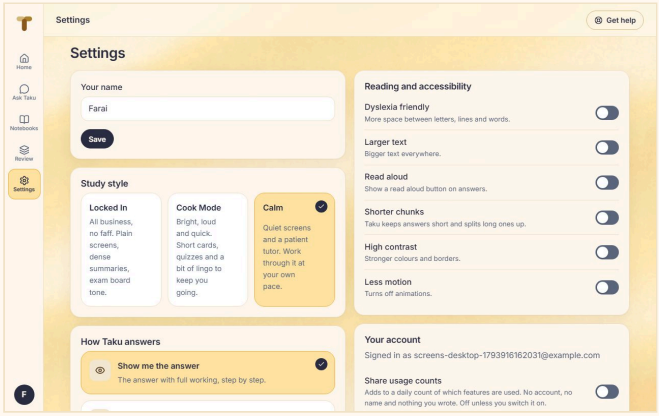


Settings, desktop

Before

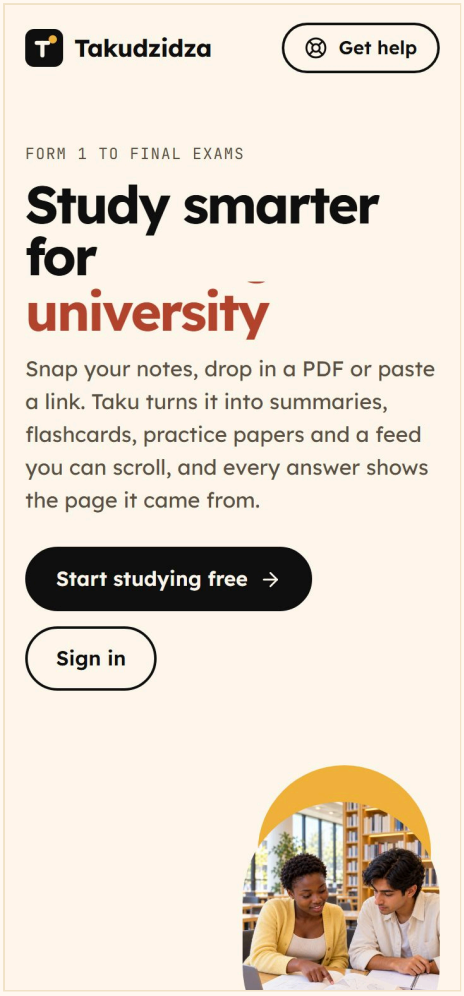


After

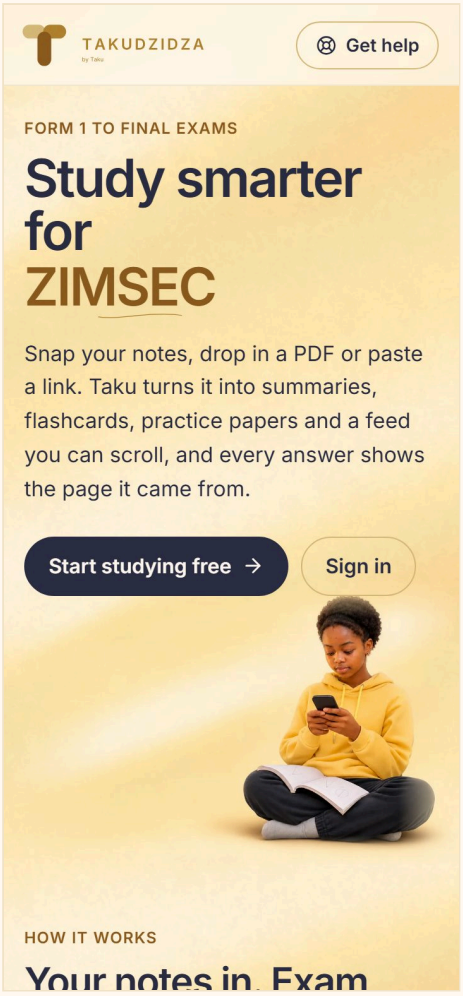


Landing, phone

Before

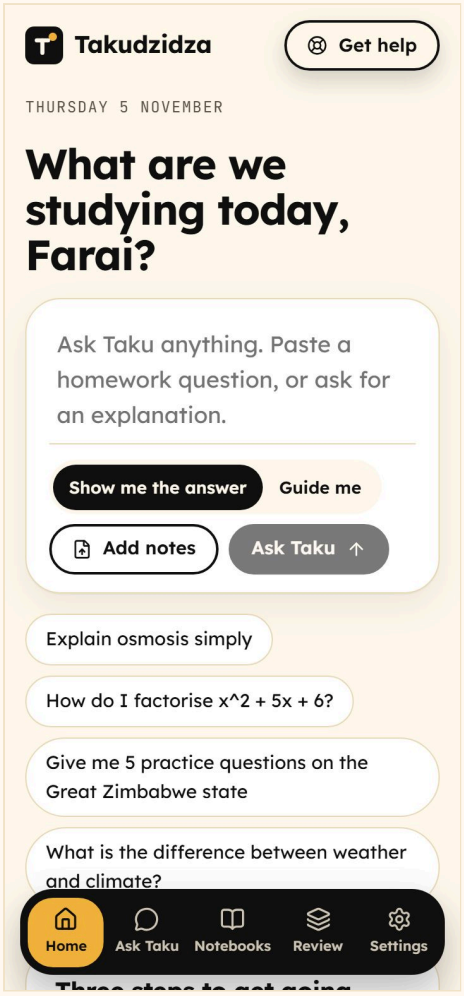


After

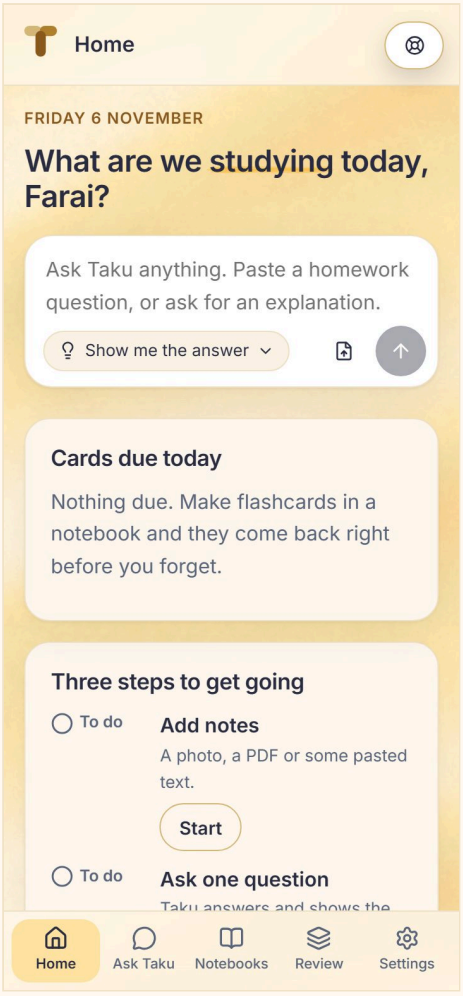


Home, phone

Before

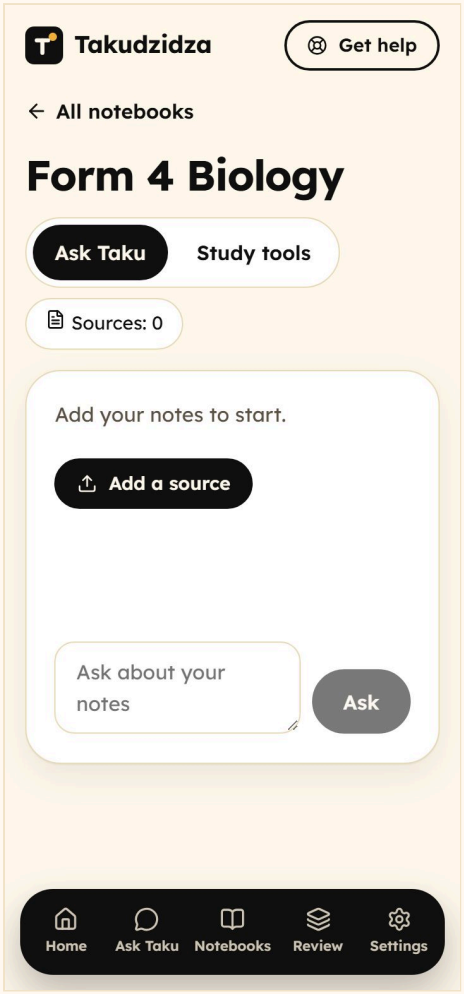


After

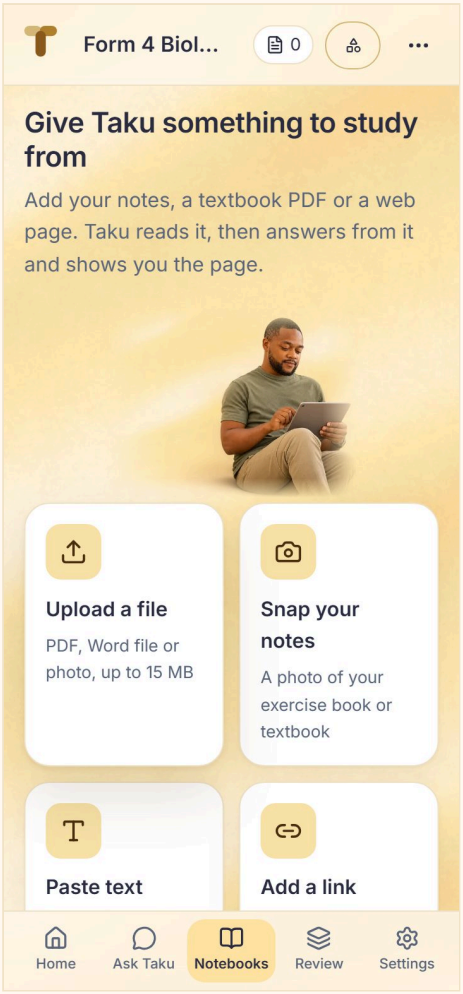


Empty notebook, phone

Before

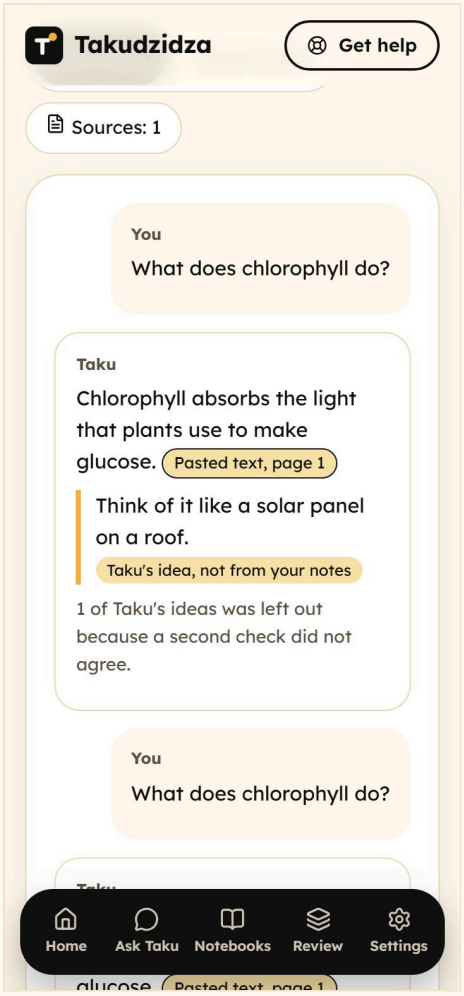


After

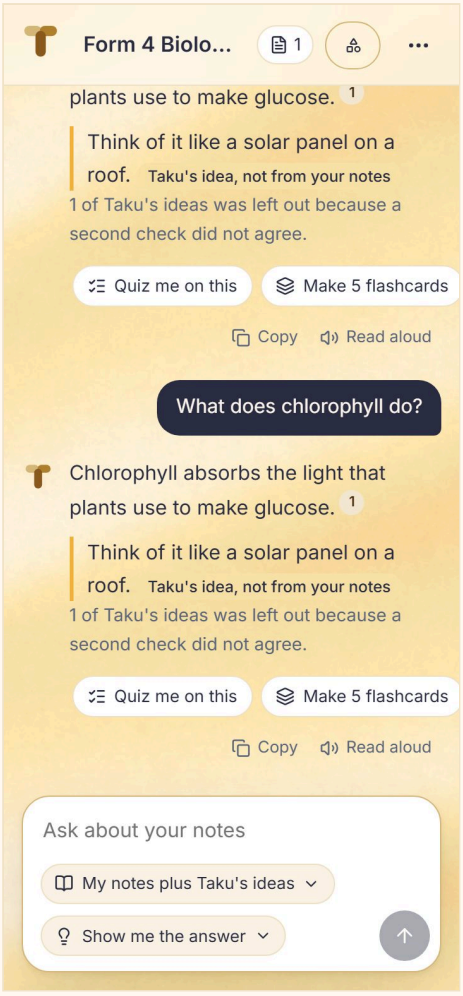


Notebook with answers, phone

Before

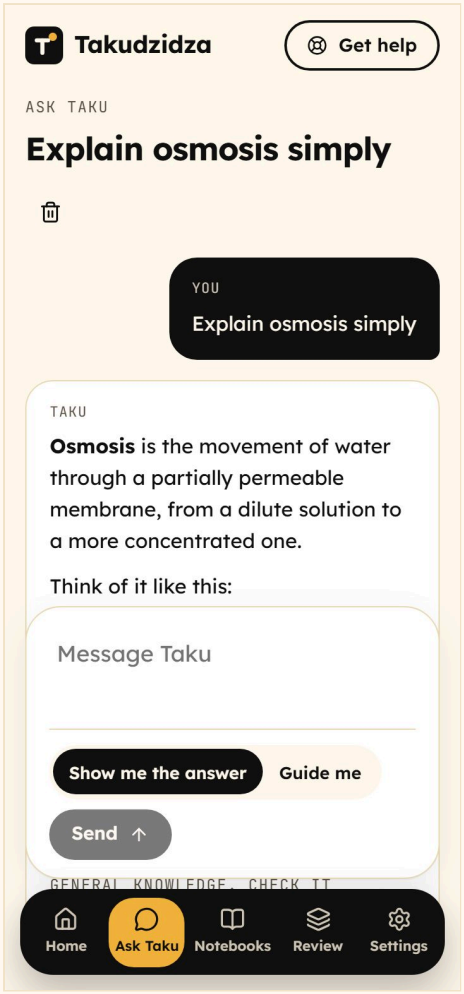


After

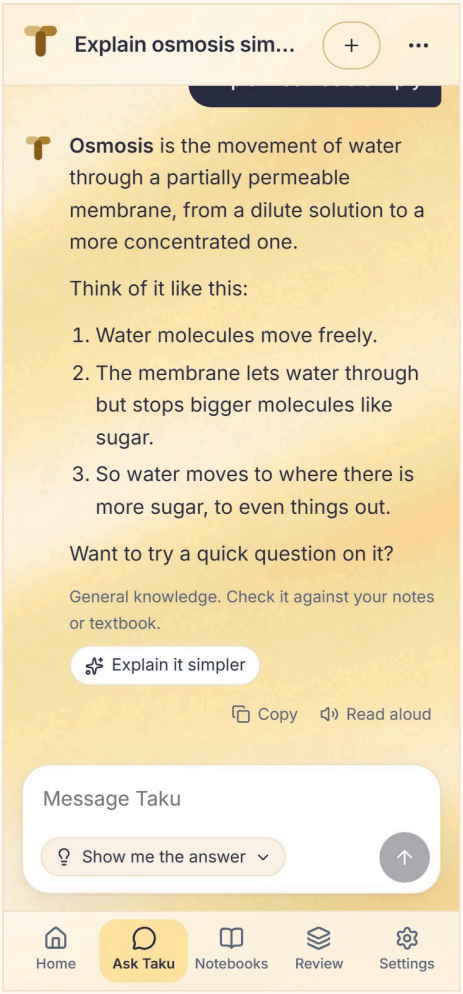


Ask Taku, phone

Before

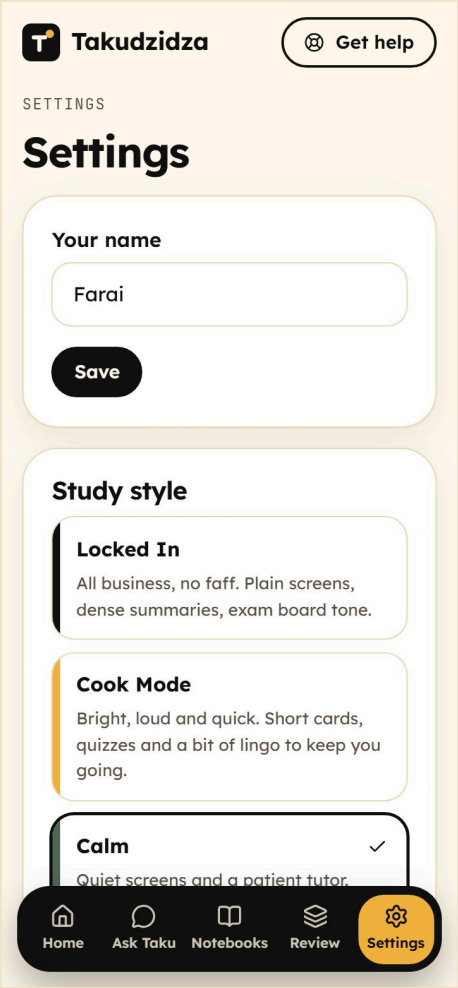


After

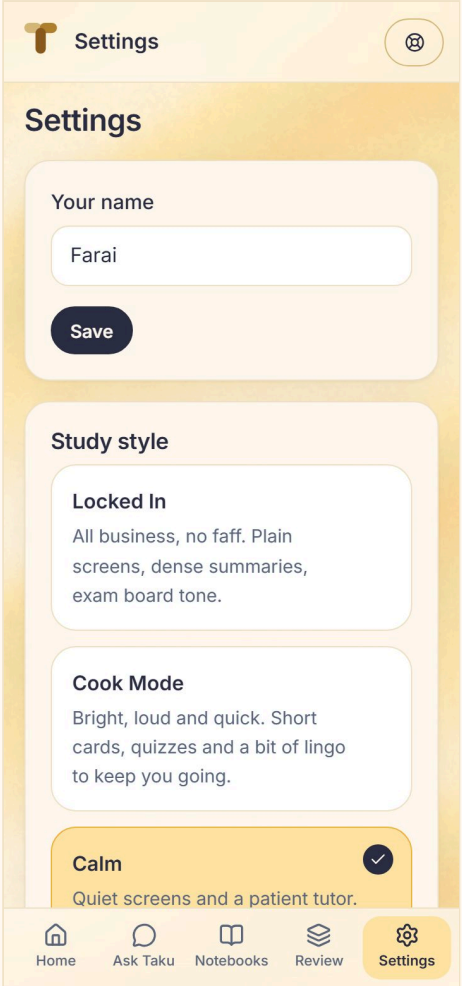


Settings, phone

Before



After



TAKUDZIDZA BY TAKU

Polish pass: warm palette and layout fixes

Every blue tone is gone and the phone notebook gives the conversation most of the screen. Live at takudzidza.vercel.app since 6 November 2026, from commit `8872345`. Rollback tag: `checkpoint-before-polish`.

What changed

- **Colours.** Body text is ink #2A2118, headings and dark fills (buttons, learner bubbles, the avatar, flashcard backs) are brown #4A3010, secondary text is #6B5A45. Dark mode runs on #1E1710 with #2A2118 panels and cream text. The old charcoal #2B2D42 and slate #5C677D are gone from the app, and a unit test fails if either comes back, or if any style colour leans blue. Sage, the success colour, was warmed for the same reason.
- **Dark textures.** Both honey waves dark files were remade by the recorded generator with warm browns only, same sizes and under their byte limits (104 KB and 65 KB). The texture and brand boards were rebuilt; the inverse mark still reads best on #1E1710.
- **Phone notebook.** Both question box chips sit on one row with short labels ("Notes plus ideas", "Answer"); the menus keep the full text. No tab bar inside a notebook or Ask Taku; the mark leads home. The chat area is at least 70 percent of a 390 by 844 screen.
- **Empty notebook on a computer.** Study tools stay folded until the notebook has a source, and the four add tiles sit in one row with no wrapped titles at 1280 px.
- **Under each answer.** Copy, Read aloud and the action chips show on the latest answer; older answers fold them away and show them on hover or focus. The note about ideas left out is now a small info icon that opens the sentence.
- **Citations and chips.** Citation markers take a tap 32 px across and show a clear focus ring. The action chips wrap on phones instead of scrolling off the edge.
- **Header.** The header lockup is the mark and TAKUDZIDZA. "by Taku" is set as text on sign in, the landing page and the footer, at 12.8 px or larger.
- **Ask Taku on a phone.** The empty screen shows the whole cutout, smaller, starting at the top instead of scrolled past it.

Contrast

Every text pair in use is held to at least 4.5 to 1 by the contrast test. The main ones:

Body text, ink #2A2118 on cream	15.0 to 1
Headings, brown #4A3010 on cream	11.6 to 1
Secondary text, grey #6B5A45 on cream	6.3 to 1
Secondary text, grey on tint #F4E8D3	5.5 to 1
Cream on brown buttons and bubbles	11.6 to 1
Honey on brown	6.6 to 1
Dark mode text, cream on #1E1710	16.8 to 1

Dark mode text, cream on panels #2A2118	15.0 to 1
Dark mode buttons, ink on honey	8.5 to 1

Checks

- Lint, typecheck, 299 unit tests and the production build pass, all in mock AI mode with no live AI call.
- Browser journeys: 8 new ones in `e2e/polish.spec.ts` for the phone question box, the folded Study tools, citation markers and the action chips. The full run had 50 passed and 2 failed: the small phone check on Ask Taku measured the starter chips outside the scroll pane, so the test now measures only the part on screen; both then passed. After folding the older footers, the polish and notebook journeys were run again: 14 passed, 0 failed, 0 skipped.
- Live: the site serves the new bundle and the new dark texture, and the landing page loads with no console errors or failed requests at 1280 by 800 and 390 by 844. No Convex code changed, so only the site was published; production settings were not touched. No account was made on production.

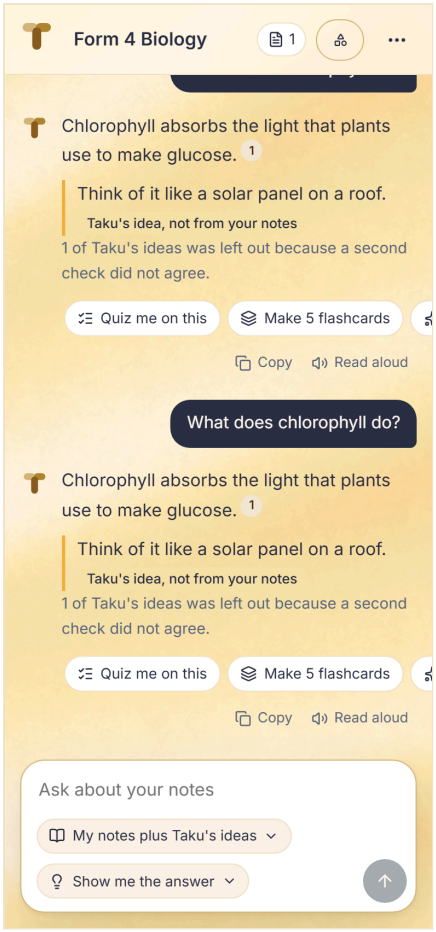
Notes

- In dark mode the primary buttons stay honey with ink text, because a brown button barely shows against the dark panels.
- Older review scripts in `art/review` still name the old charcoal for boards made earlier; nothing the app loads uses it. Earlier pages of this report show the screens as they were.

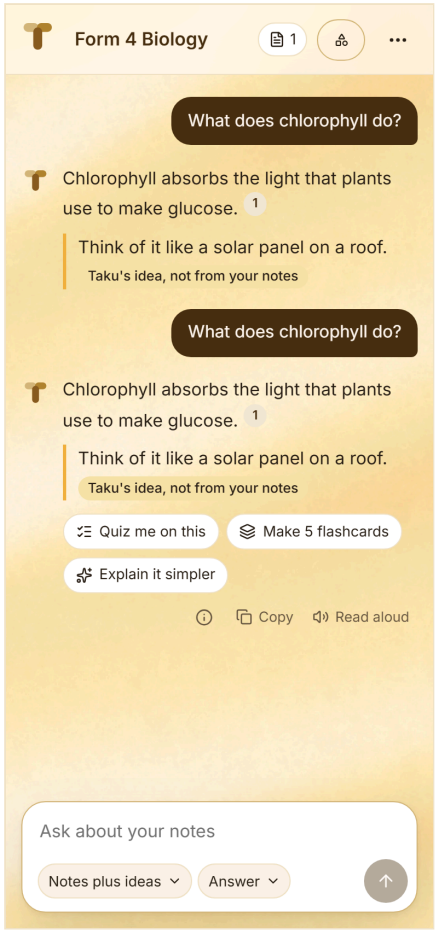
Before and after, phone (390 by 844)

Notebook with answers

Before

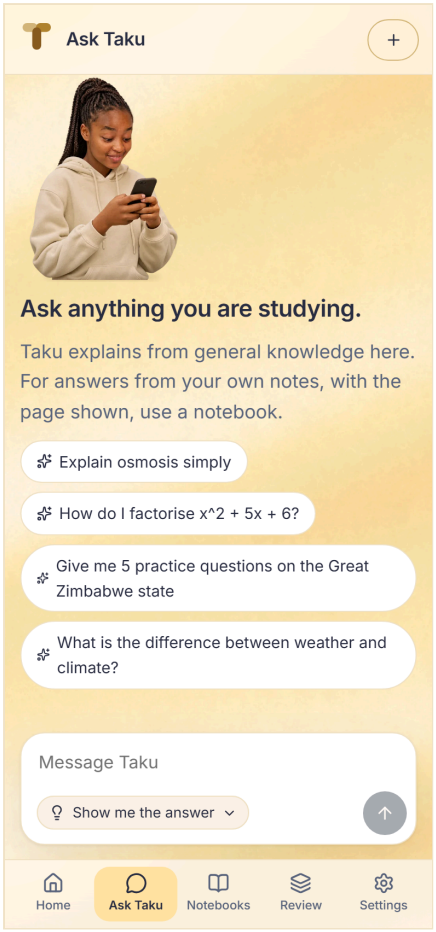


After

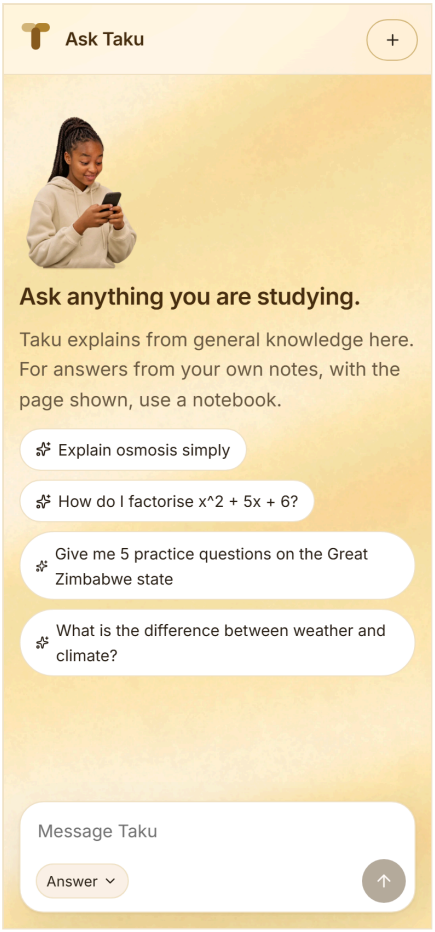


Ask Taku, empty

Before



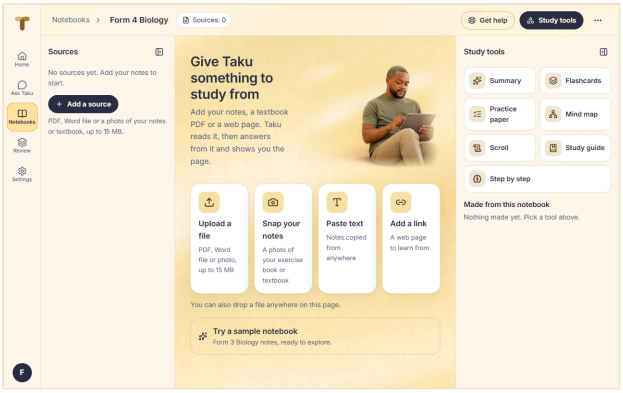
After



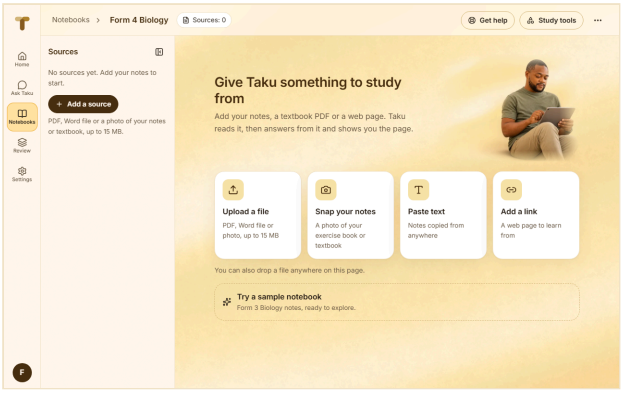
Before and after, desktop (1280 by 800)

Empty notebook

Before

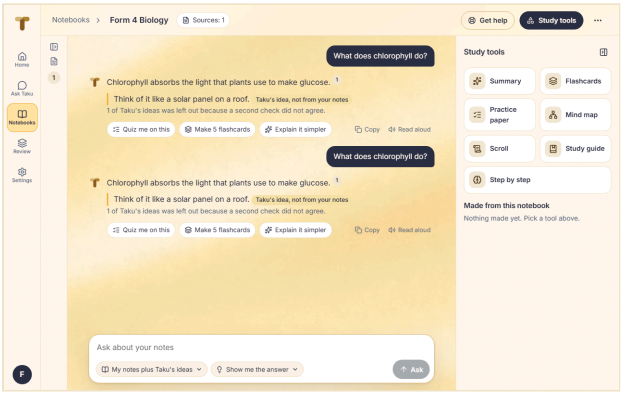


After



Notebook with answers

Before



After

